

THATO PILUSA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with a Bachelor of Science and an Associate of Science in Computer Science, backed by practical SOC experience in defensive security. Skilled at managing SIEM operations, responding to attacks, and evaluating the integrity of network and cloud security. Possesses a deep technical foundation in systems (Windows, Linux), networking, and security platforms. Proven ability to automate repeatable tasks using scripting and leverage emerging technologies to enhance operational efficiency. Aligned with industry standards (NIST, ISO27001, CIS, MITRE ATT&CK) through continuous learning, certifications, and hands-on lab simulations.

CORE SKILLS

- **Security Operations:** SIEM Operations, Threat Hunting, Incident Response, Log analysis , Endpoint & Cloud Security (Azure)
- **Frameworks & Standards:** ISO27001, NIST, CIS, MITRE ATT&CK Methodologies
- **Automation & Scripting:** PowerShell, Kusto Query Language (KQL), Lucene query syntax, HTML, Workflow Automation, AI Security Tools Integration
- **Systems, Networks & Platforms:** Windows, Linux (Ubuntu, Kali), Active Directory, Firewalls, Encryption, VirtualBox, VirusTotal, URLScan

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Analyst Intern

Snode Technologies | Feb 2026 – Present

- Ensure the effectiveness of security platforms by actively monitoring SIEM dashboards, tracking network usage, and responding to intrusions, phishing, and unauthorized activities.
- Support full-lifecycle management of security incidents, performing detailed technical reviews to identify potential weaknesses and recommend endpoint or encryption improvements.
- Improve operational workflows by evaluating new AI security technologies.

- Assist in evaluating system and network security by utilizing queries to correlate events, mapping alerts to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and analyzing threat intelligence via platforms like VirusTotal and URLScan.
- Document system configurations, incident response procedures, and analytical findings meticulously, while collaborating with cross-functional technology teams to share information security best practices.

EDUCATION

University of the People

- **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science** | Graduated January 2026
 - GPA: 3.64 / 4.00 **Cum Laude**
- **Associate of Science in Computer Science** | 2024
 - GPA: 3.41 / 4.00

CERTIFICATIONS & PROGRAMS

- **Microsoft AZ-900:** Azure Fundamentals
- **Microsoft AI Skills Fest:** Verified Credly AI Certification Badge
- **ISC2:** Cybersecurity Specialization Certificate
- **IBM:** Cybersecurity Specialization Certificate
- **Google:** IT Support Professional Certificate
- **Mastercard:** Cybersecurity Virtual Experience
- **TryHackMe:** Cybersecurity Training

PROJECTS & COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

- **Virtual Security Labs:** Routinely configure, troubleshoot, and navigate local network testing environments using VirtualBox, Kali Linux, and Ubuntu to simulate real-world attack and defense scenarios.
- **Tech Community Engagement:** Active participant in local industry meetups, including the Hacking Hub, to discuss threat intelligence, ransomware developments, and the broader cybersecurity landscape.